

The TST Trading Rules

20 non-negotiable rules across risk, entries, exits, and behavior.

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These are the rules every TST student implements before touching live capital. Print this. Put it next to your screen. Read it before every trading session until it is automatic.

RISK RULES

- Never risk more than 1% of your account on a single trade.
- Set a daily max loss of 3%. Hit it — stop trading for the day.
- Calculate your position size before you click. Never after.
- Never move your stop loss further from your entry.
- Never average down into a losing position.

ENTRY RULES

- Every trade must have a defined entry, stop, and target before entry.
- No catalyst, no trade on gap plays.
- No trade without volume confirmation on breakouts.
- Do not enter in the first 5 minutes unless you have a specific reason.
- Never chase a stock that has already moved significantly — wait for the pullback.

EXIT RULES

- Sell into strength, not weakness. Take partial profits at your first target.
- Never hold a losing trade past your stop hoping it comes back.
- Trail your stop on runners — do not give back all profits.
- Book a partial win and let the rest run.
- If a trade is not working within your expected timeframe, re-evaluate.

BEHAVIORAL RULES

- Do not trade when you are angry, distracted, tired, or emotional.
- No revenge trading. A loss is data, not an injustice.
- Review your trades every week. Your journal is your coach.
- Trade your plan — not your emotions.
- One bad day does not define you. Consistency over months defines you.

DAILY SELF-EVALUATION — FILL OUT AFTER EACH SESSION

RULE	DID I FOLLOW IT?	NOTES
Stayed within 1% risk per trade	Yes / No	
Honored my daily max loss	Yes / No	
Had an entry, stop, and target before every trade	Yes / No	
Did not move my stop to avoid a loss	Yes / No	
Did not chase or revenge trade	Yes / No	
Reviewed my trades and journaled	Yes / No	

TST RULE

The rules that are hardest to follow in the moment are the ones that matter most. Everyone can follow rules when trades are going well. The defining skill is following them when you are losing, when you feel frustrated, and when breaking the rule feels justified.

The TST Academy course covers every rule above in detail — the why behind each one and how to implement it in real trading at topstocktrading.com